Conversation track 22, 24, 25

Graham is trying to talk Gemma into running a half marathon.

Graham: Gemma. The city half marathon in March. You and me. What do you reckon?

Gemma: You're kidding, right? I get winded climbing stairs.

Graham: That's what training's for. **Just imagine** crossing that finish line.

Gemma: I'd rather imagine brunch. Seriously, what if I can't finish?

Graham: **What's the worst that could happen?** You walk a bit. Heaps of people do.

Gemma: **I'm still not convinced.** Three months of early mornings?

Graham: **Tell you what**, I'll run every session with you. Rain, hail or shine.

Gemma: Even the crack-of-dawn ones?

Graham: Especially those. Come on, **you've got nothing to lose**.

Gemma: Fine, **you've talked me into it**. But the coffee's on you.

Speak Like a Native track 23

1. What's the worst that could happen?

strong: "worst", "happen"
weak: "that could"

Câu trấn an: giọng thoải mái, xuống ở cuối. "that could" đọc lướt: "đơt-kơd". Giọng Úc thường không đọc r: "worst" /wɜːst/.

2. I'd rather imagine brunch.

linking: "rather‿imagine"
strong: "brunch"

Câu đùa: nhấn mạnh "brunch" để đối lập với "finish line" của Graham. Giọng Mỹ đọc rõ r và nối sang từ sau: "ra-đơ-ri-ma-jin".

3. Fine, you've talked me into it.

strong: "Fine", "talked"
linking: "into‿it"

"Fine" kéo dài, hạ giọng: đồng ý nhưng miễn cưỡng. Chữ l trong "talked" câm: /tɔːkt/. "into it" nối bằng âm w nhẹ: "in-tu-wit".

• Thuyết phục: giọng nhiệt tình, nhấn vào từ gợi hình ảnh (imagine, finish line, nothing to lose).
• Đồng ý miễn cưỡng (Fine…, OK…): kéo dài và hạ giọng.
• Chữ l câm trong talk, walk, could, would, should.
• Giọng Úc (Graham) thường đọc "half" là /hɑːf/ như giọng Anh; giọng Mỹ (Gemma) đọc /hæf/.

Role Play track 27

A: Gemma. The city half marathon in March. You and me. What do you reckon?

B: You're kidding, right? I get winded climbing stairs.

A: That's what training's for. Just imagine crossing that finish line.

B: I'd rather imagine brunch. Seriously, what if I _____?

A: What's the worst that could happen? You walk a bit. Heaps of people do.

B: I'm still not _____. Three months of early mornings?

A: Tell you what, I'll run every session with you. Rain, hail or shine.

B: Even the crack-of-dawn ones?

A: Especially those. Come on, you've got nothing to lose.

B: Fine, you've _____. But the coffee's on you.

Study Notes

Rain, hail or shine.
Dù mưa hay nắng.
Cách nói của người Úc (người Mỹ, Anh hay nói "rain or shine"): việc gì cũng làm, bất kể thời tiết.
Cách nói tương đương: Whatever the weather.

Even the crack-of-dawn ones?
Cả mấy buổi chạy lúc tờ mờ sáng á?
"at the crack of dawn" = lúc tờ mờ sáng, rất sớm; ở đây gạch nối thành tính từ: crack-of-dawn runs.
Cách nói tương đương: Even the really early ones?

Grammar Focus

Thuyết phục người khác

Gợi ra hình ảnh tích cực, xoá bớt nỗi lo, rồi đưa thêm một lời đề nghị hấp dẫn. Giọng nhiệt tình nhưng đừng ép.

Just imagine how good you'll feel afterwards.
Come on, **what have you got to lose**?
Tell you what, I'll pay for the tickets.

Đáp lại lời thuyết phục

Chưa đồng ý: I'm not convinced / not sold. Đã đồng ý: You've talked me into it / You've won me over. Kèm điều kiện: On one condition.

I'm **not sold** on the idea yet.
OK, **you've won me over**.
I'll come, **on one condition**.

Substitution Drill track 28

1. Seriously, what if I **can't finish**?
   a. get injured
   b. come last
   c. give up halfway

2. I'm still not **convinced**.
   a. sold on it
   b. sure about this
   c. on board

3. Fine, you've **talked me into it**.
   a. won me over
   b. convinced me
   c. worn me down